

IN PROFILE

Giuseppina Strepponi

Born in 1815, singer Giuseppina Strepponi was the daughter of a cathedral organist. After studying at the Milan Conservatory, she made her stage debut as a soprano in 1834 and was soon an international celebrity, singing lead roles in operas by Rossini, Bellini, and Donizetti. She performed in most of Verdi's early operas, including Nabucco, before her voice gave way under the strain of an excessive performance schedule. After her retirement, she became Verdi's lover in Paris in 1847. Married in 1859, they remained together happily until her death in 1897.



STREPPONI WITH THE MUSIC SCORE OF NABUCCO, ANONYMOUS
ARTIST

Art meets life

Verdi's drive to fulfill the insatiable demand for his musical dramas in any case left little time for political activity. He took a thoroughly businesslike attitude to composition, seeking to maximize his earnings. Down-to-earth and unintellectual, he